

TIMELINE

- **February 1818** Born Frederick Bailey, an enslaved person, in Tuckahoe, Maryland. His mother's enslaver, Aaron Anthony, is rumored to be his father.
- **1826-27** Sent to Baltimore to Hugh and Sophia Auld. Sophia Auld teaches Frederick to read.
- **January 1834** Auld sends Frederick to work for "slave-breaker" Edward Covey.
- **1836** Makes first failed escape attempt. Frederick is returned to Baltimore where he is hired out to a shipyard. Plans another breakout.
- **September 1838** Escapes from slavery and changes his last name to Douglass. Moves to New Bedford and marries Anna Murray.
- **August 1841** Speaks at an American Anti-Slavery Society meeting. Begins lecturing for the Massachusetts Anti-Slavery Society.
- **May 1845** His first autobiography, *Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass*, is published. He flees to England, where English supporters "purchase" his freedom for \$711.66.
- **1847** Buys a printing press and begins publishing the *North Star* in Rochester, New York.
- **1848** Attends first women's rights convention. Meets John Brown. Begins sheltering slaves fleeing north on the Underground Railroad.
- **1851** Merges *North Star* with Gerrit Smith's Liberty Party Paper to form *Frederick Douglass' Paper*.
- **1855** Publishes his second autobiography, *My Bondage and My Freedom*.
- **1861** Urges recruitment of Black soldiers and a proclamation of freedom for the slaves to undermine the Confederate war effort.
- **1863** Becomes a recruiter for the 54th Massachusetts Infantry, the first regiment of Black soldiers; his sons enlist.
- **1864** Meets with President Abraham Lincoln to formulate plans to lead Black Americans out of the South in case of a Union defeat.
- **1872** The Equal Rights Party nominates him for the vice-presidential candidacy. Douglass declines.
- **1877** Buys Cedar Hill, a mansion in southeast Washington, D.C., which becomes his home.